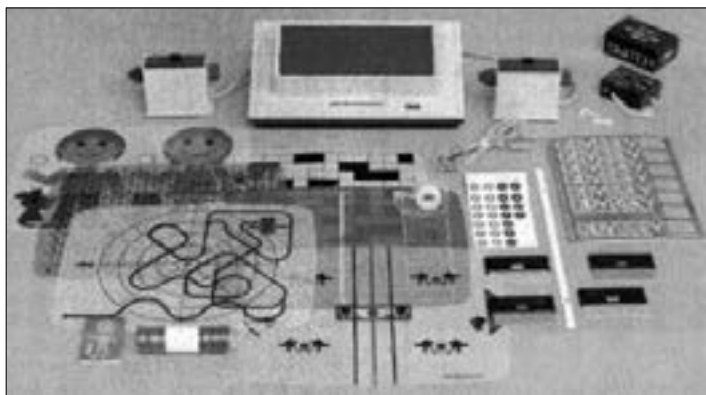


ry and a button for firing the ball over the net. The game entertained visitors at the Lab for a whole year before it was dismantled in 1959.

These early games ran on university mainframes and were largely restricted to programmers and students who developed them as projects or as a hobby. A number of games were developed in the '60s by students, and development in games led to a number of other inventions. The most notable among these was the invention of the UNIX operating system, which was partly developed by Ken Thompson, who wanted to play a game called *Space Travel* which he was developing.

Many of the innovations even in the modern computing world come from the gaming industry. Sound cards were developed for the addition of digital-quality sound to games. These were later improved for music and audiophiles. Similarly, graphics cards and 3D accelerators were developed for GUIs (Graphic User Interface) and games.



The Magnavox Odyssey was the first home gaming console to be made

It wasn't until the '70s that video games became a major source of entertainment for the masses. With the release of the Magnavox Odyssey in 1972, video games entered the average home. It was built around analogue electronics. The console connected to a home TV